FREED-HARDEMAN UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY SCHOLARS' DAY

Celebrating Scholarship and Academic Achievement

APRIL 24, 2026

KEYNOTE SESSION

8:30-9:20 A.M.

Scholarship, Faith and the Formation of Virtue	Dr. Nathan Howard, University of Tennessee at Martin	Dryden Auditorium Main Stage

DR. NATHAN HOWARD

Nathan Howard is professor of history at the University of Tennessee at Martin, where he is completing his twentieth year. Prior to joining UT Martin, he taught at the University of Cincinnati, the University of Arkansas and Wake Forest University. He teaches courses in world civilizations, ancient Greece and Rome, early Christianity and late antiquity/early medieval Europe, and has led student travel to Greece, Turkey and Ireland. From 2006 to 2015, he also served as volunteer assistant coach for the UT Martin cross country and track programs.

Dr. Howard's research focuses on early Christianity, particularly the fourth century, with interests in bishops, gender, letter writing and rhetoric in late antiquity. He has published articles and book chapters and presented at conferences across the United States and England. His book, "Christianity and the Contest for Manhood in Late Antiquity" (Cambridge University Press, 2022), reflects this work. In 2025, UT Martin honored him with the Outstanding Teacher/Scholar Award.

Howard earned degrees from Harding University, Baylor University and the University of Arkansas. He has been active in the Skyhawks for Christ campus ministry, participated in domestic and international mission work, and served as a part-time preaching minister in Arkansas and Mississippi.

POSTER PRESENTATION

9:20-9:40 A.M.

Dorothea Tanning and "The Truth About Comets"	Hannah Welch, Brian Bundren	Dryden Auditorium Lobby
A Look at "Kindred Spirits" by Asher B. Durand	Emma Voreis, Brian Bundren	Dryden Auditorium Lobby
Who Was Norman Rockwell?	Callie French, Brian Bundren	Dryden Auditorium Lobby
How Tax Avoidance Schemes Become Criminal Tax Evasion	John David Rodgers, Brian Bundren	Dryden Auditorium Lobby
Analysis of Off-Target Mutations in a CRISPR/Cas9 Cytosine Base Edited Phytopathogen Pectobacterium versatile	Elliana Chumley, Jeanne Seibel, Dan Chang, Joe Deweese, Caleb Kersey	Dryden Auditorium Lobby
Preparation and Analysis of Ancient DNA Samples Using Oxford Nanopore Sequencing	Elliana Chumley, Olivia White, Lily Simpson, JT Moore, Thabo Mahlaha, Joe Deweese	Dryden Auditorium Lobby

ORAL SESSION 1

9:45-10:00 A.M.

A Hebraic Analysis of Jephthah's Vow (Judges 11)	Seth Johnson, Jim Gardner	Dryden Auditorium Main Stage
"Old Companions" by John Frederick Peto	Amelia Vestal, Brian Bundren	Dryden Auditorium Balcony A
Rectangle Packing at Higher Orders	Emily Seibel, Jared Collins	Dryden Auditorium Balcony B
Nursing Mission to Ghana: Medical	Molly King, Cassie Hunter, Emma Daniels, Chris White	Dryden Auditorium Balcony C
Exploring Computational Folding of the Unstructured C-Terminal Domain Topoisomerase IIβ by AlphaFold3	Xavier Falkenheim, Joe Deweese	Dryden Auditorium Balcony D
Stewardship that Sustains the Artist and the Art	Cliff Thompson	Dryden Auditorium Butts Family Conference Room
The Role of Heart Rate Variability (HRV) and Its Relationship to Health and Fitness	Maurice Williams	Dryden Auditorium Deans' Conference Room

ORAL SESSION 2

10:10-10:25 A.M.

The Reception of Susanna in Christian History	Jacob Farber, Doug Burleson	Dryden Auditorium Main Stage
Isolation, Surrealism, and the Subconscious in Franz Kafka	Evie Hazel, Margaret Payne	Dryden Auditorium Balcony A
Using Arificial Intelligence to Automate Investing Research	Ethan Thomas, Charlie Smith	Dryden Auditorium Balcony B
Nursing Mission to Ghana: Evangelism	Gabriel Yaeger, Jessica McGee, Ella Daniels, Meg Thompson, Chris White	Dryden Auditorium Balcony C
Examining the Synergistic Effects of Etoposide and ICRF-193 Against Topoisomerase IIα	Lily Simpson, Joe Deweese	Dryden Auditorium Balcony D
The Shadow Docket and Judicial Power	Birdie Greene, Stephen Morris	Dryden Auditorium Butts Family Conference Room
The Role and Authority of Health-Related Licensing Boards	James H. Dalton	Dryden Auditorium Deans' Conference Room

ORAL SESSION 3

10:35-10:50 A.M.

God Hates Sinners	Parker Cotts, Donnie DeBord	Dryden Auditorium Main Stage
From Script to Space: Digital Design for Stages & Interiors	Anslee Hulen, Cliff Thompson	Dryden Auditorium Balcony A
Rendering Unto Self: How We Rationalize Tax Evasion	Catherine Grisham, Logan Chambers, Austin Ketchum, Brandon Lancilotti	Dryden Auditorium Balcony B
Nursing Mission to Ghana: Community	Jenna Pilkinton, Bo Woods, Logan Summers, Marci-Claire Russell, Chris White	Dryden Auditorium Balcony C
Our New Machine Helps! Analysis of Transcription reporter construct pRU1701 in the Phytopathogen Pectobacterium Versatile	Zoe Imel, Caleb Kersey	Dryden Auditorium Balcony D
"Where You Lead, I Will Follow": Magical Realism in "Gilmore Girls" and "The Robber Bride"	Margaret Payne	Dryden Auditorium Butts Family Conference Room
Advanced Analytics in Athletics	Will White	Dryden Auditorium Deans' Conference Room

ORAL SESSION 4

11:00-11:15 A.M.

"What is Your Own?": The Radical Patristic Views of Social Justice in the 4th Century	Josiah Fuller, Donnie DeBord	Dryden Auditorium Main Stage
Resilience, Patience and Social Support as Predictors of Post-Traumatic Growth in Military Personnel	Aubrey Garrison, Reagan Cross, Ammie Spellings, Chris Creecy	Dryden Auditorium Balcony A
Wealth Manager's Paradox: Bridging the Gap Between Behavioral Economics and Proactive Tax Planning	Halle Burton, Brandon Lancilotti	Dryden Auditorium Balcony B
Assessing Nurses' Knowledge: Preventing Ventilator Associated Pneumonia	Ellie South, Raven Wentworth	Dryden Auditorium Balcony C
Investigations Into a "Street Fight" Between Two Bacteria Isolated on the Campus of Freed-Hardeman University	Nathan King, Caleb Kersey	Dryden Auditorium Balcony D
Even the Bots Cry Out: A Case Study on the Use of ChatGPT for Spiritual Reflection	Kenan Casey, Matthew Sokoloski, Loren Warf, Wesley Baker	Dryden Auditorium Butts Family Conference Room
MUSICAL PERFORMANCE **The Parting Glass**	Luke Gibbs, Tyce Wilkerson	Draughon Center for Musical Arts

ORAL SESSION 5

11:25-11:40 A.M.

Predicting Conflict Resolution Within the First Five Years of Marriage as a Function of Gender, Relationship Confidence, Communication Pattern and Marital Satisfaction	Rachel K. McDowell, Macey G. Gardner, Carissa A. Thompson, Matthew E. Mitchell , Chris Creecy	Dryden Auditorium Balcony A
Application of Bioinformatics Tools to Processing DNA Sequencing Data	Joseph (JT) Moore, Thabo Mahlaha, Joe Deweese	Dryden Auditorium Balcony B
Investigating Prosodic and Structural Transfer from Sotho-Tswana to English in Adult Learners	Kailey Garrett, Susan Lankford	Dryden Auditorium Balcony C
Evaluating Editing Efficiency in a CRISPR Pectobacterium Versatile Mutant	Elliana Chumley, Jeanne Seibel, Caleb Kersey	Dryden Auditorium Balcony D
MUSICAL PERFORMANCE **Franz Liszt's Piano Sonata in B Minor (3rd Movement)**	Adam Booher	Draughon Center for Musical Arts

ORAL SESSION 6

11:50 A.M.-12:05 P.M.

MUSICAL PERFORMANCE **From Concept to Recorded Product**	Michael Yopp, Legacy Jazz Ensemble	Dryden Auditorium Main Stage
Predicting Anxiety Among Millennial Parents as a Function of Parenting Style, Online Social Support and Problematic Smartphone Use	Jenna L. Street, Sophia Haddad de Lima, Andres M. Martinez, Chris Creecy	Dryden Auditorium Balcony A
An Update on the Establishment of an Arboretum on the Campus of FHU	Nathan King, Caleb Kersey and Paul Fader	Dryden Auditorium Balcony B
The Role of Bilingual Physicians in Enhancing Patient Transparency	Lily Simpson, Perry Hardin	Dryden Auditorium Balcony C
Preparation and Analysis of Ancient DNA Samples Using Oxford Nanopore Sequencing	Elliana Chumley, Joe Deweese	Dryden Auditorium Balcony D
MUSICAL PERFORMANCE **Using ACE Studio - Ai Music Software for Songwriting**	Alan Kinningham	Draughon Center for Musical Arts
Did One Man Change the Bible? Erasmus, the KJV and 1 John 5:7-8	Tucker Cates, Doug Burleson	Hope Barber Shull Academic Resource Center 150